VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE TESLA DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF TUE OCT 20 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Results day, with a merger in the air

Tesla reports its third quarter after Wednesday's close. The night before, on SpaceX's earnings webcast, Elon Musk said Tesla and SpaceX have each formed special committees of independent directors to study a merger at the request of shareholders, and that he is staying out of their talks as "a conflicted party," The Guardian reported. No terms have been agreed.

TSLA rose 1.54% to $373.71 on Tuesday, the best showing among the "Magnificent Seven" megacaps, Investopedia reported, and gained another 1.2% after hours, according to Bloomberg Law.

TODAY · Q3 EARNINGS

Third-quarter results after Wednesday's close

Wed Oct 21 · results after the close · live Q&A webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT

The date and time come from Tesla's October 2 8-K; the webcast streams on ir.tesla.com. Bloomberg's consensus calls for $28.13 billion in revenue, about flat from a year earlier, adjusted earnings of 44 cents a share, adjusted EBITDA (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization) of $3.66 billion and operating income of $760 million, a 2.7% margin, up from $400 million and 1.4% in the second quarter; Tesla's own compiled consensus has free cash flow at negative $4.51 billion on $7.77 billion of capital spending, Yahoo Finance reported. A year ago Tesla earned 50 cents a share on $28.10 billion. The most-backed shareholder questions ask how the Cybercab fleet grows beyond Austin while the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) reviews it, when unsupervised FSD reaches customer cars, what Cybercab costs per paid mile and when Optimus will start earning revenue, Not a Tesla App lists.

I · FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD)

First drives on v14.3.13

An early tester calls it "another major evolutionary step, but still a little bit awkward."

Early impressions

After three short trips on FSD (Supervised) v14.3.13, tester Whole Mars Catalog (@wholemars) wrote that the car "reversed out of my driveway much more quickly than previous versions," "parked perfectly 3/3 times for each destination" and steered around a car stopped in its lane at a green light "without skipping a beat," TeslaNorth reported. In Mad Max mode, he said, the car drove "so aggressively that it was sometimes uncomfortable going over dips or bumps in the road."



A Tesla Cybercab on Harrison Street in San Francisco on June 12, 2026.

PHOTO: 9YZ, "TESLA CYBERCAB - SAN FRANCISCO - JUNE 2026," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 · CROPPED

The build reached AI4 cars overnight into Tuesday in update 2026.38.5.10 with the same release notes as v14.3.12, including the MLIR rewrite of the AI compiler and runtime credited with

"20% faster reaction time," and Tesla had not posted about it on its @Tesla or @TeslaSI accounts, TeslaNorth noted. There were no reports yet of it reaching HW3 cars, which run v14.3 Lite; TeslaFi still counted a single car on the update, Not a Tesla App shows.

Robotaxi questions for the call

Tesla began commercial Cybercab service in Austin on September 3; NHTSA has sent a special order with 21 requests about how Tesla self-certified the car, which has no steering wheel or pedals, and answers are due October 30 after the agency granted 30 days rather than the extension to November 20 that Tesla sought, Yahoo Finance reported. More than 300 Cybercabs give driverless rides in Austin, Dallas is next, and Robotaxi hours now run until midnight, according to Not a Tesla App.

II · SALES & DEMAND

A delivery beat, a weaker U.S.

Shanghai had its best month of the year in September while U.S. sales fell by about a fifth.

Tesla delivered 486,532 vehicles in the third quarter, including 478,237 Model 3 and Model Y, and produced 464,391; deliveries rose 1.3% from the second quarter and beat the analyst consensus of 461,974 by 5.3% but were 2.1% below a year earlier, when buyers rushed to claim the expiring federal EV tax credit, Not a Tesla App noted.

Cox Automotive estimates Tesla sold about 144,100 EVs in the U.S. in the quarter, down nearly 20%, still about 54% of the U.S. EV market. Shanghai's September wholesale volume of 95,366 was its best month of 2026, with exports up 58% and domestic sales down 9%, and registrations across the EU, U.K. and European Free Trade Association (EFTA) rose 43.3% from January through August, according to Yahoo Finance.

QUICK HIT

Ferrari CEO Benedetto Vigna gave last week's Roadster presentation 10 out of 10 for technology and for presentation at a Quattroruote conference in Milan: "As a European, thank you for showing us how that, even in an old world, you can still innovate and dare," Not a Tesla App reported. Roadster production starts in 2028.

III · ENERGY & CHARGING

Storage short of estimates; three new Supercharger sites

Deployments rose to 13.7 gigawatt-hours, below the 15.9 analysts expected.

Tesla deployed 13.7 gigawatt-hours (GWh) of energy storage in the quarter, up from 13.5 GWh in the second quarter and 12.5 GWh a year earlier, Yahoo Finance noted, but short of the 15.9 GWh analysts expected, according to Not a Tesla App.

Tesla Charging announced new Superchargers in Latham, New York, on Troy Schenectady Road with 16 stalls (post, 8:02 p.m. EDT Tuesday); Nakhon Pathom, Thailand, at a Global House store with four (post); and Alès, France, with six (post, 3:43 a.m. EDT Wednesday).

IV · THE MERGER & TERAFAB

"A lot of merit to combining the companies"

Musk backed the idea of a Tesla-SpaceX merger on Tuesday but said it is far from certain.



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022. The December 3 annual meeting will be held there and online.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

"I do think there's a lot of merit to combining the companies," Musk said on SpaceX's call. "There's a lot to be gained from cooperating on developing superintelligence software." He said a deal would need approval from 50% of all Tesla shareholders, not just a majority of those voting, and that "some people out there assume that a SpaceX and Tesla merger is a certainty. I think that would be overstating it," Bloomberg Law reported. SpaceX is valued at about $2 trillion and Tesla at nearly $1.5 trillion; SpaceX has bought more than $100 million of Cybertrucks, and its AI unit is a major buyer of Tesla's utility-scale batteries.

Barclays suggested last week that a deal could be announced before Tesla's December 3 annual meeting, with SpaceX the likelier acquirer, though neither company nor Musk has committed to one, Reuters reported.

What the proxy discloses

Tesla's proxy for the December 3 meeting reports Musk's 2025 CEO Performance Award of about 423.7 million restricted shares at $158.4 billion in the summary compensation table; none of its 12 tranches has been earned, each requiring a market value of $2 trillion to $8.5 trillion plus operating targets, Reuters reported. Musk exercised all 303.96 million options from his 2018 award on June 16, owns nearly 20% of Tesla including 207.5 million pledged shares, and borrowing against those shares is capped at the lesser of $3.5 billion or 25% of their value. Tesla also obtained an SEC no-action letter for a voluntary retail-investor voting program.

Terafab's timeline

Terafab, the chip venture of SpaceX and Tesla, aims to reach volume production by the third quarter of 2028 and to have a first test chip, built from static random-access memory (SRAM) circuits, working around May or June next year at its Austin research facility, Musk said, Reuters reported. "I put big error bars on this because we don't know if we will actually achieve this or not," he said. Earlier Tuesday he posted that "the value of Terafab's output will place it in the top 20 of country GDP in a single building."

QUICK HIT

Wes Morrill @wmorrill3, Tesla's Cybertruck lead engineer, wrote at 11:27 p.m. EDT Tuesday, quoting the Las Vegas police department's Cybertruck patrol fleet: "Cybertruck is a great Police vehicle low cost per mile tough can idle without polluting the neighborhood super performance plenty of accessory power for all those lights can even provide power in case of a local outtage"

V · SEC FILINGS

Nothing new before the report

No filings for Tesla, Inc. (CIK 0001318605) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Tuesday and 8:45 a.m. EDT Wednesday.

Takeaways

1. Tesla reports Q3 after Wednesday's close; the webcast is at 5:30 p.m. EDT.
2. Analysts expect about $28.13 billion in revenue and 44 cents a share.
3. Musk said Tesla and SpaceX committees are studying a merger.
4. Early FSD v14.3.13 drives were faster but "a little bit awkward."
5. TSLA rose 1.54% to $373.71 Tuesday.

Latest: DEFA14A · Oct 19, 5:12 p.m. EDT — Additional proxy materials: a board letter urging votes for all three proposals at the December 3 meeting. Filing

Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4) — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at $360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5; 25,972.25 shares afterward (filed Sep 9).

SOURCES

Posts by @TeslaCharging, @elonmusk and @wmorrill3 on X; SEC EDGAR; Tesla Investor Relations; Yahoo Finance, Investopedia, Bloomberg Law, The Guardian, Reuters, Not a Tesla App, TeslaNorth; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Wikimedia Commons (9yz, CC BY 4.0; Larry D. Moore, CC BY 4.0).

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Up 1.5% into the report

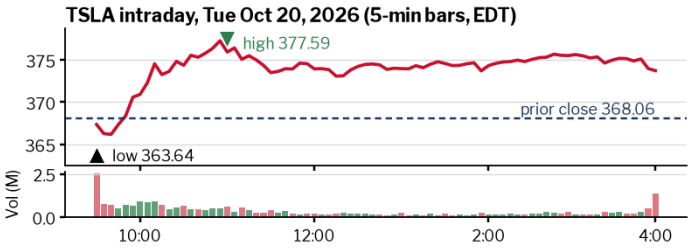
TSLA led the "Magnificent Seven" as the Dow rose 1% and the Nasdaq Composite ended fractionally lower, Investopedia reported; GM fell about 7% after its results.

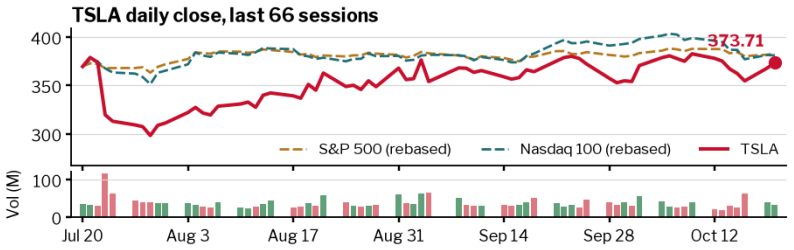
CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$373.71	+$5.65	$370.28	$377.59	$363.64
Tue Oct 20, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*+1.54% vs $368.06*	*regular session*	*11:00 a.m. EDT bar*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**52-WEEK RANGE**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**YEAR TO DATE**
31.66M	$297–$499	$1.48T	−0.41% / −0.42%	−16.90%
−10.2% vs 30-session avg 35.25M	*$297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to $498.83 (Dec 22, 2025)*	*3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Jul 16) × close*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs Dec 31, 2025 close*

52-WEEK RANGE, OCT 20

low $297.38 · Jul 29 | close $373.71 | high $498.83 · Dec 22, 2025

50-day avg $361.11 200-day avg $387.26





As of close Oct 20, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 20 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	YTD
TSLA	**+1.54%**	**−0.41%**	**−0.42%**	**−16.90%**
S&P 500	+0.28%	−1.19%	−0.67%	+12.67%
Nasdaq 100	−0.13%	−3.53%	−3.25%	+16.79%
RIVN	+0.73%	−7.03%	−19.08%	−36.94%
GM	−6.84%	−8.23%	−8.17%	−5.20%
F	−0.25%	+0.41%	−7.74%	−7.39%

OPTIONS (CBOE, WED OCT 21, 8:38 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 23	237,023	225,728	0.95	98.1%	$400 / $130
Oct 26	34,422	18,575	0.54	69.8%	$455 / $350
Oct 28	7,641	8,046	1.05	64.3%	$420 / $350
All expiries	**3,000,244**	**2,331,931**	**0.78**		**30-day IV index 46.4**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 21

Strong buy	4
Buy	15
Hold	21
Sell	2
Strong sell	2
Mean rating (1 = strong buy)	2.36
Mean target (38 analysts)	$397.83 (+6.5%)
Median target	$412.50
High / low target	$600.00 / $128.11

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	70.93M
Change vs. mid-September	−4.4%
Short % of float	2.01%
Days to cover	1.79
Held by insiders	17.81%
Held by institutions	43.68%
BlackRock, Jun 30	5.42%
Vanguard, Jun 30	4.66%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 20 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS $1.08)	346.0
Forward P/E (EPS est. $2.17)	172.3
Price/sales (rev. $103.6B)	14.2
Beta (5-year monthly)	1.92
50-day average	$361.11 (+3.5%)
200-day average	$387.26 (−3.5%)
Q3 EPS est. (25 analysts)	$0.45
Q3 revenue est. (27)	$28.25B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 20	Cantor Fitzgerald	Overweight	$485
Oct 15	GLJ Research	Sell	$24.86
Oct 12	Jefferies	Hold	$350 to $400
Oct 8	Tigress Financial	Buy	$550
Oct 7	UBS	Neutral	$385 to $391
Sep 28	JPMorgan	Neutral	$445 to $415
Sep 25	StoneX	Buy	$475

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Wed Oct 21	**Q3 results after close; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT**
Fri Oct 23	Weekly options expiry (largest near-term OI)
Fri Oct 30	Cybercab answers due to NHTSA
Sat Nov 7	In-person meeting drawing closes, 12:59 a.m. EST
Wed Dec 2	Proxy voting deadline, 11:59 p.m. EST
Thu Dec 3	**Annual meeting, 4:00 p.m. EST**

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 20). Consensus, targets, rating actions, short interest (as of Sep 30), ownership (holders as of Jun 30) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Wed Oct 21, 8:44 a.m. EDT; P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) and price/sales recomputed at the Oct 20 close. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Jul 16, 2026. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Tuesday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the $372.50 strike at Tuesday's close. Earnings date: Tesla 8-K, Oct 2. Meeting and drawing: DEF 14A, VoteTesla.com. NHTSA deadline: Yahoo Finance.